



THE ACE

massages in varying intensities, all adjustable via either the infotainment system or the physical knobs.

The seats are ventilated for both heating and cooling, and you also get electronic adjustments for seat belt height to release or heighten tension. There are two memory slots for each of the four massive seats, which can hold six-foot frames with ample thigh and perfect lumbar support and shoulder support.

REAR TOUCHSCREEN REMOTE

The central column includes individual AC vents with temperature and air flow control. The touchscreen remote for rear passengers show date, time, digital speedometer, current driving mode, entertainment source choice, rear seat ventilation and massager settings, and use the rear seat adjust-

ers to move the front passenger seat forward. This gives the chauffeured passenger extensive control over the car's settings.

INSTRUMENT CLUSTER

The instrument cluster in the Bentley Bentayga includes electromechanical needles for the speedometer and tachometer, and a central digital panel. There are six tabs displaying a digital speedometer, short and long trip meters, time/date, car notifications (washer fluid status, electronic assist status, etc.), music playback status, telephone contacts, 3D navigation and terrain information, all operable from steering buttons.

Controls on the steering wheel include chrome toggles to adjust volume (to the right fork) and MID settings (to the left fork), navigate

settings on the MID, view notifications and details, a customisable shortcut button, navigation voice assist, call reception/rejection and voice command.

UPHOLSTERY AND OTHER DETAILS

The dual tone leather upholstery of the Bentayga uses generous veneer inserts, impeccably stitched leathers, chrome paddle shifters, the analogue centrepiece watch, retro AC vents and controls. Little things like a foldable tray for rear passengers, soft locking doors, warm ambient lighting, door-mounted ashtrays to the rear, ample storage and more simply add to surprises that keep on coming.

THE DRIVE

The Bentayga uses a 6.0-litre, W12 twin-turbo engine that produces 608 brake horsepower and 900Nm of torque. This is mated to an 8-speed transmission, and you get eight drive modes including terrains. Despite the massive chassis, when you push it the Bentayga can accelerate to 100kmph in a blazing 4.1 seconds.

The Bentayga can be freakishly fast on the highway, reaching up to over 220kmph, and the pliant steering wheel adds to the handling. The electromechanical steering wheel is light when in city, and weighs up on the highway.

The Bentayga applies intelligent techniques to adjust power delivery, transmission shifts, suspension balance and driving quality depending on the mode you choose. Particularly on off-roading tracks, you can lift the suspension to increase ground clearance, which makes a lot of difference when you take it to rocky terrain.

BOTTOMLINE

The Bentley Bentayga makes a statement, and heads turn everywhere it goes. The 6kmpl mileage and wide dimensions mean it is a bit of a paranoia-driven roller coaster in narrow, busy Mumbai streets, but that's not what it is about anyway.

It is meant to prance free down highways, not trundle along in crawling city traffic. **FI**



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